was our constant endeavour to ensure high standards of habitat for the residents. We also kept ourselves aligned with various government directives for Smart Cities, giving stimulus to digitization, sustainability and integrated planning. In doing so, Delhi Cantt was the first Discom to have initiated power trading, thereby providing impetus to digitization and savings to the exchequer. The Cantt Board too has to be managed and the functions coordinated to avoid duplication of effort and wasteful expenditure, for which my experience as the AQ at Chakrata came in handy.

There are as many as thirteen land parcels all over Delhi, amounting to approximately 8000 acres, some unoccupied, that have to be kept under watch. The security of all the personnel is also the responsibility of the Area, including preventing thefts and burglaries. The GOC, Delhi Area is also the Estate Officer with authority to levy fines in case of unauthorized occupation of family quarters with powers akin to a judge. The educational needs of the children have also to be met and that too comes under the purview of the Delhi Area. The educational institutes under Delhi Area range from schools catering for kindergartens, high secondary and colleges, including a medical college. As the GOC, being the Patron of all these educational institutes, one has to really go into detail to ensure all facets of incisive growth and selection of faculty to improve the standards. The sheer range and scope of activities carried out by Delhi Area is mind-boggling. The multidimensional facets of this appointment project challenges that need immense energy and positivity to deal with. It was quite like managing a municipal corporation. But it is also a great learning experience and one that stood me in good stead.

The second most important ceremonial activity, which is once again coordinated by Delhi Area, is Independence Day.

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